

rise, corruption and crime, apart from etching out a rather confused foreign policy and failure to keep a check on the internal security situation. These men have failed to formulate a vision that benefits the common man. VITULL K. GUPTA, *Bathinda*

Oligarchic India

Shankkar Aiyar's column was a telling commentary on the suffering of the masses at the hands of the elite ("Dismantle Oligarchies", March 8). It is true that democracy in India is a sham. Most of the governments are formed by elected representatives who themselves are facing criminal charges. Politics is abhorred as a career opportunity by the middle class. Many bright students would slog for years trying to enter IITs or clear the civil services, but no one thinks of entering politics. Government in India today is not democracy but oligarchy. The time has come for fresh blood to be injected into the political class.

BHUSHAN JINDAL, *Jalandhar*

Train to Bengal

The rail budget with no rise in passenger fares and freight charges, new trains, extensions and expansions is an ordinary one ("Trinamool Express", March 8). But corresponding infrastructure has to be built up and security

strengthened. Railways Minister Mamata Banerjee has used the budget and its bounties for West Bengal, aiming at the Writer's Building. It remains to be seen if the 'Trinamool Express' will reach its destination.

A. JACOB SAHAYAM, *Thiruvananthapuram*

Honing Hockey

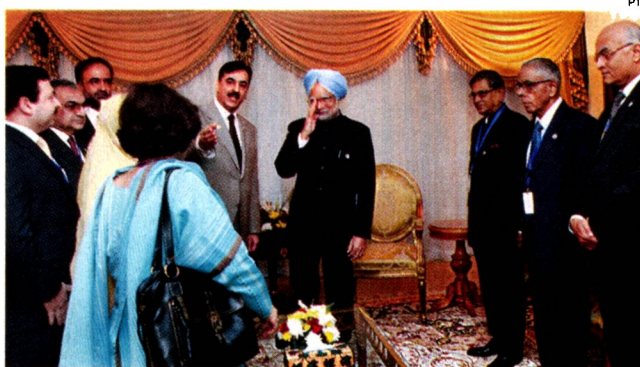
It is not so much India's

professional managers from outside the system and a players' representative.

VINOD C. DIXIT, *Ahmedabad*

Death Race

The article on student suicides in West Bengal was shocking ("Dying Young", March 1). There is a need to generate a system where professional help is easily available by



Due to the bitterness caused by Indira Gandhi's anti-US policy, the US would never trust India completely and hence support Pakistan. We will have to fight our own war against terrorism.

A.K. SHARMA, *Chandigarh*

failure to make it to the Olympics that is alarming but the fact that, barring a few exceptions, most people have lost serious interest in the game ("Playing Catch", March 8). Nobody appreciated our hockey team when they won the Asia Cup and now everybody is cursing them for not qualifying for the Olympics. We need a totally new team with pro-

way of psychiatrists. Counselling must be made mandatory, right from schools to colleges. PREM K. MENON, *Mumbai*

Corrigendum

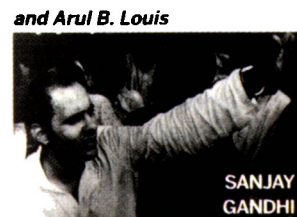
'Hot New Jobs of the Decade' (March 15), wrongly described Siddhartha Roy, chief operating officer (COO) of Hungama, as its CEO. The error is regretted. EDITOR

30
YEARS
AGO IN
INDIA
TODAY

MAY 16-31, 1980

The Sanjay Dimension

As a harsh summer sun begins to roast the Indian plains, and a pall of torpor descends upon most living beings, a 33-year-old member of the Lok Sabha is coolly limbering up for a carefully planned exercise. The prevailing lethargy of the summer will be wrenched aside next fortnight as Sanjay Gandhi, the most powerful of MPs, makes a perfectly timed sprint towards the cockpit of power. As nearly 16,000 local politicians jostle ravenously for the 2,234 seats in this month's Assembly elections in nine states, nobody will deny Sanjay's all-powerful master-tactician's role. His conviction that his strategy will pay off is even stronger. As he unhurriedly prepares for the grand entrance, the drums are beating the message loud and clear. "Sanjay Grip Tightens," raves a recent headline in *Current*. Editorial comment is recognising this fact. "The pattern of distribution of tickets for the nine assemblies," remarks a newspaper, "has clearly demonstrated Sanjay Gandhi's emergence as the most powerful leader of the ruling party." **by Prabhu Chawla**



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